concerns and resolve issues. APEDA's strategic agreements and collaborations, such as the Preclearance Cooperator Payment Plan with USDA APHIS, GACC registration for vegetable enterprises, and efforts towards organic MRA's with Australia, South Korea etc underscore APEDA's proactive stance in navigating in the global regulatory landscapes.

While APEDA continues to evolve and adapt, its multifaceted initiatives contribute not only to the growth of India's agricultural exports but also to the empowerment of farmers, women-led FPOs, and innovative entrepreneurs. With an eye on the future, APEDA remains committed to steering India towards becoming a global agricultural powerhouse, contributing to a self-reliant and economically vibrant nation.

In tandem with 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat,' APEDA has been actively focusing on organic production. The National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP)- India's export standard for Organic products, for which APEDA serves as the Secretariat, underscores its commitment to sustainable and organic farming practices, for spearheading Organic exports. This not only addresses the growing global demand for organic products but also empowers our farmers economically. Towards further collaboration, India is actively negotiating with Australia, South Korea to finalize Mutual Recognition Agreements on their Organic Regulatory Systems.

A recent milestone in this journey is the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) signed between APEDA and M/s Lulu Hypermarket, a fast-growing retail chain having more than 200 outlets in the Middle East and Asia. This strategic partnership positions India as a consistent and quality supplier of agricultural products. The MoU facilitates promotional activities for APEDA's scheduled products within Lulu Hypermarket's expansive retail chain, enhancing the visibility of Indian agricultural products.

HARBINGERS OF SELF-RELIANCE: APEDA'S VISION FOR A GLOBAL 'AATMANIRBHAR BHARAT'

At the heart of APEDA's strategies lies a resolute commitment to the government's vision for a self-reliant India- 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat, being 'Vocal for Local,' and from 'Local to Global'. APEDA's initiatives focus on promoting Geographical Indications (GI) tagged products, organic production, millets and their value added products.

APEDA's emphasis on promoting Shree Anna-Millets aligns with the government's vision for a healthier and more diversified food basket. With efforts made in the last more than one year and especially under the International year of Millets-2023, a range of value added products such as pasta, noodles, breakfast cereals, Ice cream, biscuits, energy bars, snacks etc have been developed and mainstreamed, giving a new dimension to Shree Anna and connecting them to value chain of Exports. The International Year of Millets 2023 further amplifies APEDA's commitment to promoting this ancient grain globally. The acceptance of India's proposal for setting up group standards for millets showcases India's commitment to shaping global agricultural norms.

One of APEDA's key strategies involves the promotion of locally sourced products with GI tags, emphasizing their unique qualities and cultural significance. This not only preserves its rich heritage but also positions these products for global recognition. APEDA has been periodically organizing several training and awareness programmes for producers, farmers, and other authorised users of agricultural GI produces, with special focus on improvement of their traceability and quality control protocols. APEDA has been also working on the promotion of the agricultural GI products in all virtual national and state level GI Trade Fairs that deal with fresh or natural produce. These Fairs are excellent platforms where producers, manufacturers, traders, exporters and consumers can converge. In all the international B2B events that APEDA has been participating in, products like Basmati rice, Black rice from the North East, Lemons from Assam, have found many buyers and have seen an increase in their sales.



EXPORT EXCELLENCE
APEDA'S DIGITAL FRONTIER AND AGRI-INNOVATION

In embracing technological advancements, APEDA has initiated various IT-enabled activities to streamline export processes. The Millets Portal and Indian Millet Exchange stand as testament to APEDA's commitment to leverage technology for greater efficiency. Capacity building, another cornerstone of APEDA's strategy, empowers stakeholders, especially farmers, for sustained success. The efforts are being made for strengthening the market intelligence as being required for the trade to empowering exporters with crucial information for informed decision-making on a global scale.

APEDA is also upgrading and improving the IT backbone of the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) so as to improve oversight and compliance thereby further enhancing trust in the certification system.

VISION FOR INDIA'S AGRICULTURAL EXPORT SUCCESS

As APEDA looks ahead, the vision extends to sustained growth, increased diversification, and a stronger global presence for Indian agricultural products. The focus remains on harnessing technology, expanding the export basket through strategic additions, and exploring new markets. The trajectory of India's global Agri trade ranking over the past three decades reflects APEDA's significant contribution, moving up from the 29th position in 1988 to the 7th position in 2021, APEDA's proactive interventions, strategic collaborations, and relentless pursuit of excellence have enhanced India's visibility and reputation in global agricultural trade.

APEDA's journey unfolds as a saga of resilience, innovation, and transformative leadership, echoing India's agricultural renaissance on the global stage.